

► REASSIGNED 2026-08-27. NOT Episode 1.

Candidate for episode 3 or 4.

Stephen-ruled after reading the cold open: *"This story is not going to be a candidate for ep1 but it certainly is looking good for #3 or #4."*

The premise survives and is not parked. What it loses is the pilot slot, and with it the install cliff, the FTUE budget and the 35-to-40-second pre-play target. As a mid-season episode a four-minute opening is affordable and a returning player is already bought in. See `the-same-house-twice-cold-open-v1.0.md` for the prose and the timing that moved it.

△ FOUR UNREPAIRED DEFECTS. This document is NOT clean.

It went to prose in parallel with a third audit, and that audit found four things that were never fixed.
Whoever builds this inherits all of them.

1. **The recipients are missing from the sweep.** The provider who receives the escalation, the authority that receives the doctor's statement, the office that receives the grave application, the pharmacy that holds the note. **"It takes weeks" describes the outcome this document wanted, not the recipient's earliest action.** The claimed latency is unpaid suppression.
2. ★ **The antagonist's warning is dated AFTER the refusal it is said to cause.** Winnie refuses on Day 3; Colin first learns a podcaster is asking on Day 4. **He did not get there first, so Part D's causal account is reversed and the refusal is currently generated by character alone.**
3. **Capacity is treated as permanent from Day 3.** It is decision-specific and time-specific. At lead 12 Winnie is visibly worse, which is new clinical information to everyone able to act, and the sweep never runs the response it creates. **Her refusal becomes a plot device at lead 12, and that is the answer to the question this spine asked.**
4. **Three first-action dates follow the authored lead order rather than earliest availability.** Ally to Del is Day 1 not 2 to 3; Del opens the file Day 2 not Day 3; Marion is reachable Day 5 not Day 8. **The instrument was run and then fudged.**

★ **The earliest-action sweep has since gained a recipient column BECAUSE of this spine, and it has never been re-run here. Re-run it before anything else.**

Still open: ruling questions J4 safeguarding, J5 exhumation authority and J7 forfeiture, plus the expansions the third audit asked for: name each receiving authority, its first mandatory action, any interim current-risk duty, and the earliest date for each stage.

THE SAME HOUSE TWICE

THE SPINE, v1.2 — THE GRAPH REPAIR

A delta on v1.1. Everything in v1.1 Parts A and B is unchanged and still authoritative: the two deaths, the pharmacy query, the Ruth week, the lives given to Edith and Gordon, the three canon rulings. **What changed is the graph, and only the graph.** Parts C, D, E, F and G below replace their v1.1 versions outright.

Written against ChatGPT's second audit (REWORK, seven findings, 94 to 99 per cent confidence). All seven accepted. One partial correction is recorded and does not rescue anything: finding 2 uses a 36 to 48 hour half-life, which is materially longer in an 81-year-old with reduced renal function. Its second point stands regardless and is the fatal one. **An elevated level shows toxicity. It does not show who administered it.**

★ THE ONE MOVE

v1.0 shut a route. v1.1 declared an open route worthless. **Both were the same mistake: the plot needed somebody who could act not to act.**

Everything fires on Day 3. All of it is correct. None of it is fast enough.

Nobody is suppressed in v1.2. Yardley makes the offer. Yardley reports Gordon. Josie escalates. Del acts. Every professional in the episode does exactly what their job requires, on the first afternoon, and **the machine then moves at the speed of the machine** while a woman gets worse in a house on Orchard Steps.

The obstacle is not access and it is not silence. It is an eighty-one-year-old woman's absolute right to refuse a blood test, and the fact that the man poisoning her got to her first with a story that makes every subsequent approach look like part of it.

★ **The episode is not about getting people to act. It is about what happens when everybody acts properly and she is still in the house.**

★ STEP 1b. THE EARLIEST-ACTION SWEEP

This is the instrument that killed v1.1, run before the pre-flight, per the pipeline. Authored order ignored. Day 1 is the day Ally plays Josie's call.

Person	What they can lawfully know, and when	Earliest competent action	Day	Why it does not end the episode
Ally	Josie's account, Day 1	Take it to Del and to the GP named on the title-adjacent trail	2 to 3	She has no power at all. That is the point of her
Del	Everything Ally has, Day 2	Receive it, open a file, and act on Yardley's report the moment it arrives	3	She cannot enter a competent adult's home, cannot compel a blood test, and cannot arrest a man for shopping. She does the correct slow thing
★ Yardley	That his own symptomatic patient may be receiving excess digoxin, Day 3	★ Rings Winnie the same afternoon. Medication review and blood test, honestly and without deception, because that is ordinary care	3	★ She refuses. With capacity. He documents it. His duty is discharged and he cannot compel her
★ Yardley	His own conduct on Gordon's certificate, Day 3	★ Reports it. Formal statement, professional self-referral, application concerning the grave	3	★ It is accepted and it is acted on. A certificate review and an exhumation application take weeks. None of it touches Winnie
Josie	Her client deteriorating, ongoing	★ Escalates the deterioration to the provider and the GP. Her duty renews on the new facts	1	The provider does contact the GP, who has already rung. Winnie tells them all the same thing
Marion	Only what Ally tells her	Request Edith's records as next of kin	8	Edith was cremated nine years past the pharmacy window. There is nothing to find and never will be
Colin	That a podcaster is asking, Day 4	★ Tell Winnie first	4	★ It works. See below
Winnie	That her doctor, her carer and a stranger all want something from her	Refuse. She is competent and it is her right	3	★ This is the wall, and it is the only legitimate kind: one the world supplies rather

Person	What they can lawfully know, and when	Earliest competent action	Day	Why it does not end the episode
				than one the plot needs

★ **The sweep passes, and it passes without a single suppression.** Every first-action date is Day 1 to Day 4, every action happens, and the episode survives because **correct action is slow and consent is absolute.**

PART C. THE ACCESS LEDGER (replaces v1.1 Part C)

Co. Nothing is closed. Everything is slow.

No route in this episode is shut and none is declared worthless. The three that matter all fire on Day 3 and all deliver exactly what they should:

- **Yardley's clinical offer** delivers a documented refusal by a competent adult.
- **Yardley's report on Gordon** delivers a live official process measured in weeks.
- **Josie's escalation** delivers a provider ringing a GP who has already rung.

★ **The constraint is time and consent, and both are real.**

C1. Corrections to the v1.1 ledger

Item	v1.1 said	v1.2
Josie's safeguarding report	"It exists" — with no route to it. Finding 7 was right: that is not access	★ Josie has her own copy, because she wrote it and kept one. It is hers to hand over. And handing a document about a client to a journalist is a data breach that costs her registration. The route is clean and the cost is real
Marion warning Colin	A records request "is one phone call from Orchard Steps"	★ Withdrawn. Finding 7 was right: no lawful person would tell him. That false cost is deleted and Decision 2 is rebuilt on a true one
Yardley's admission	"Worth nothing"	★ Withdrawn. It is worth a great deal and it is acted on immediately. It is simply not worth it <i>in time</i>
Winnie's refusal	Asserted, never shown	★ Shown, on Day 3, to her own doctor, after an honest clinical explanation. Finding 4 satisfied

Everything else in the v1.1 ledger stands, including the closed list: Gordon's certificate, Edith's records in Ally's own hands, Edith's pharmacy record gone under R8, the cremation, the Voss cameras, and Winnie's blood.

PART D. THE ANTAGONIST (replaces v1.1 Part D)

★ Finding 2 accepted in full: "he has already started" is present danger and not an evidential trap. He can taper and walk and the level proves nothing about who. The claim is deleted.

So he is not trapped, and the episode stops pretending he is.

From	Cheapest action	Why
Always	Kindness, in public, for a year or two	The method, not the disguise
Three weeks ago	Started raising the dose	Present danger, and no irreversible trace
Day 4, and it is now the load-bearing act of the episode	★ Tell Winnie a podcaster has been asking questions about him	★ This is what closes the medical route. When her doctor rings the same week asking her to come in for blood tests he has never mentioned before, she hears the campaign Colin described. His weapon was always her dignity. In v1.2 it does structural work rather than decorative work
Any time after	★ Taper the dose and be a man who was kind to three people	★ He can. He genuinely can. He does not, because nobody has yet given him a reason to think he needs to
If told the rules changed	Stop and go	He does not know. Decision 4

★ He is not caught in a trap. He is a man nobody has yet frightened, and frightening him is one of the things Ally can choose to spend.

PART E. THE CLOCK (replaces v1.1 Part E)

△ **Day 12 is deleted. Finding 5 was right and the defect was mine twice over:** Colin cancelled the visits nine days before Day 1 and Winnie confirmed it, and then I kept Josie walking into that house for eleven more days. **A notice period preserves a payment, not a right of entry.**

The clock is now two true things, neither of them arithmetic.

One, and it is the one the player feels: Winnie is getting worse on screen. Nausea, unsteadiness, tiredness, and further each time Ally sees her. No number, no countdown, no interval pattern. **The player watches an eighty-one-year-old woman decline across sixteen leads and knows exactly why.**

Two, and it is dated: the official machine has a date on it. Yardley's report goes in on Day 3. **The application concerning Gordon's grave is listed, and the date it is heard is a real date on a real list.** That is the day Havenbay stops needing Ally, and it is weeks away.

★ The two clocks run against each other. The official one is certain and slow. The human one is uncertain and quick. **Everything Ally chooses is a bet on which arrives first.**

PART F. SIXTEEN LEADS (replaces v1.1 Part F)

Phase One, leads 1 to 6 — everyone does their job

#	What happens	What changes
1	Josie's call	A woman is being killed now, and the caller will not be recorded
2	The title history	Sixteen years on one page and the same name twice
3	Del, then Yardley	★ Both act, correctly, that afternoon
4	★ It all works, and none of it is fast enough	Winnie refuses her doctor. The grave application is listed for weeks away. Decision 1
5	Colin got there first	He has already told Winnie what Ally is. Every door on Orchard Steps is now shut and she was not wrong to shut it
6	Edith and Gordon	A stenographer and a man with pigeons

Midpoint, lead 7 — the green lamps

Marion says the sentence she has carried for sixteen years. **The player stops investigating a property and starts investigating a poisoning.** Still the merge board's best shot at the evidence-turn question.

Phase Two, leads 8 to 11 — the only thing left is her mind

#	What happens	What changes
8	Marion has standing, and standing is not proof	Decision 2
9	Colin	Warm, open, delighted, and he shows Ally the garden
10	★ The machine is working and it is weeks away	Del says so plainly. Nobody can compel a blood test and nobody is going to
11	★ The only route left runs through Winnie changing her mind	Decision 3

Phase Three, leads 12 to 16 — two clocks

#	What happens	What changes
12	Winnie, worse	And still herself, and still right about being patronised
13	The consequence of Decision 3	Either she has been asked by someone she cannot dismiss, or she has been asked by a stranger again
14	The grave application has a date	Havenbay will get there. After
15	★ He does not know the rules changed	Decision 4
16	The close	Somebody is alive, or somebody is answered for

PART G. THE FOUR DECISIONS (replaces v1.1 Part G)

★ Finding 7 accepted: three of four costs were false or inaccessible. All three are rebuilt on true ones.

#	Lead	Class	Choice	Rejoins
1	4	A	Take Josie's copy of her own report, or leave it with her	7
2	8	B	Tell Marion, or let her keep the version she has	10
3	11	C	Ally asks Winnie, or Marion does	14
4	15	A	Tell Colin the rules changed, or hold two more days	close

Arithmetic unchanged and still passing: two Class A, one Class C, rejoins 3 / 2 / 3 / 1, no fork before the current branch rejoins, leads 7, 10 and 14 shared.

Decision 1 • lead 4 • Class A

Take it. Josie's report is dated seven weeks before Ally existed, signed, and about a named client. It is the difference between a podcaster's theory and a professional's recorded concern, and it is what makes the official machine move faster than it otherwise would. **Leave it with her.** Ally has only her own voice, and the machine moves at its own pace.

★ **The cost is now real and lawful:** handing a document about a client to a journalist is a data breach. **It ends Josie's registration, not just her job.** She offers it anyway.

Decision 2 • lead 8 • Class B

★ **The false cost is gone.** Marion requesting records does not warn Colin, and no lawful person would tell him.

Tell her. She has standing Ally never will, and the green lamps enter the record as a daughter's account rather than a podcaster's anecdote. **Edith was cremated and the pharmacy record expired nine years ago, so Marion will spend the rest of her life on a question that has no answer available to it. Let her keep the version she has.** Sixteen years of an ordinary sad death stay ordinary and sad, and **the one detail that makes the whole pattern legible never enters the record at all.**

Irreversible: a woman's remaining years, or the only witness detail that explains what happened.

Decision 3 • lead 11 • Class C

★ **v1.1's deception version is deleted. Finding 3 was right: Yardley can ask honestly, and he did, on Day 3, and she said no.** The question is no longer how to get the test. It is **who asks her again.**

Ally asks. A stranger, a podcaster, and precisely the ghoul Colin described to her on Day 4. It confirms everything he said and it may close the door permanently. **Marion asks.** A woman whose mother died in that house, saying it to her face, and Winnie cannot dismiss her the way she can dismiss Ally. **It also puts Marion in a room with Colin, and Marion is not able to sit opposite that man and say nothing.**

Irreversible: Ally's last standing with Winnie, or what Marion does in that room.

Decision 4 • lead 15 • Class A

★ **Rebuilt on finding 7. It no longer asks police to tolerate lethal harm, because the police are already moving and Ally is choosing whether to preempt them.**

Tell him. He stops, he goes, **Winnie lives** — and she never believes a word of it, because the man who was kind to her vanished the week a podcaster started telling lies about him. The grave application loses its living subject and Marion's question closes with nothing in it. **Hold two days.** The application is heard, the machine takes over, and all three are answered for. **Two more days of Colin in that house with a woman he is already poisoning, and he has no idea he needs to stop.**

Irreversible: two deaths never answered for and Winnie's last friendship intact but false, or the two days.

Counterfactual

Remove every decision: everyone still acts on Day 3, Winnie still refuses, the application is still heard, and Colin is caught after she dies. ★ **The counterfactual is not a world where nobody tried. It is a world where everybody tried correctly and it did not matter, which is the episode's whole argument.**

PART H. WHAT THE SWEEP AND THE PRE-FLIGHT NOW SAY

Objection 11, the one that killed the parked premise and holed v1.0 and v1.1: ★ **no route is closed, no route is declared worthless, and the sweep above is the demonstration rather than the assertion.**

Objection 13, small numbers: ★ **there is now no interval pattern, no countdown of weeks and no arithmetic anywhere in the episode.** The clock is a woman getting visibly worse and a date on a court list.

Objection 7, cast: unchanged and still the risk. **Opening cap remains four names.**

Finding 6, Josie's duty: she escalates on the new facts, at lead 1, and it is in the sweep. **Ruling question J4 is still open and still needed**, but the spine no longer treats its recommended answer as fact.

Still open, and honestly: J4 safeguarding, J5 exhumation authority, J7 the forfeiture rule. **J5 now matters more than it did**, because the grave application is one of the two clocks.

VERDICT ON THIS DOCUMENT

This is the third structure for this premise and Stephen has ruled it the last one. It goes to prose now rather than to another audit.

★ **What is different about this version, and it is the only argument for it:** the two previous spines needed somebody who could act not to act. **This one needs nobody to do anything except their job and one woman to exercise a right she unquestionably has.**

If the opening written from it does not grab a reader, the premise is retired and the next candidate begins at step 1b.